

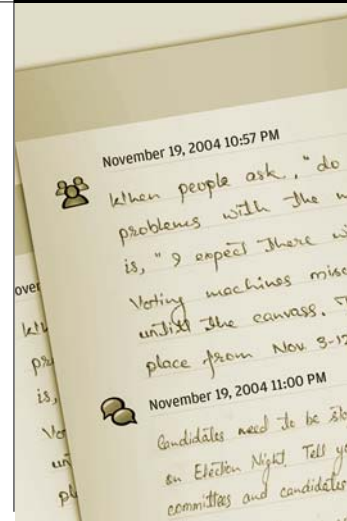


Madhu Menon
Head Chef
Shioh Far-Eastern Cuisine,
Bangalore

Having been an Internet professional before I made a career switch, I did plan on a chef blog as part of the Shioh Web site, right from the design stages of my restaurant. From what I have seen, I am the only restaurant chef in this country to post a blog. Celebrities such as Sanjeev Kapoor and Tarla Dalal do have their own Web sites, but these require paid membership. In contrast, my blog is up there for free.

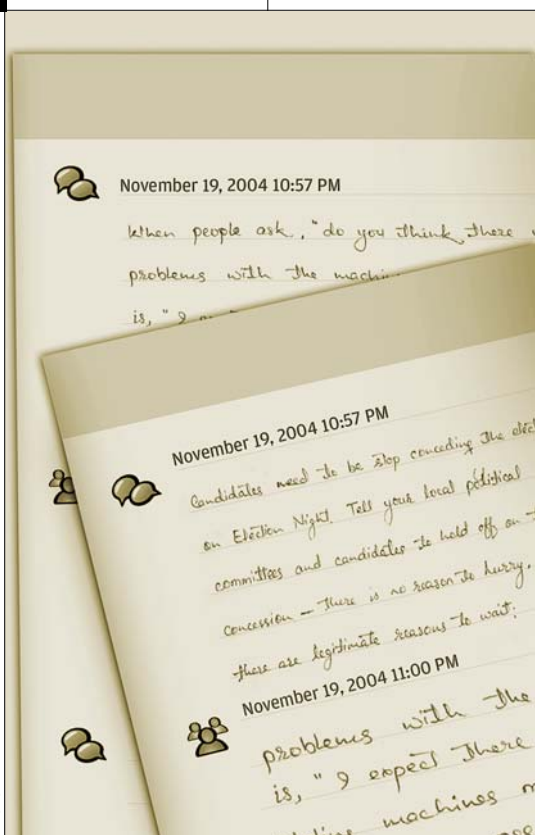
Professionally, it gives me credibility as a chef, especially since Shioh is a chef-driven restaurant. It's refreshing to get unfiltered, useful information from a company's managing director directly. It lowers my cost of retaining customers and helps brand recall. By giving them something to come back to, Shioh's brand stays fresh in their minds and helps repeat business.

One of our main challenges is to educate the customer enough to start appreciating new flavours and foods. This can only happen when you are in touch with them regularly.



EXCHANGE

FROM making random viewpoints public to posting reviews about serious business projects and industry events, Web Logs (blogs, for short) have come a long way. A dynamic tool that fosters quick analysis and inputs from clients and customers alike, they are an innovative way of accelerating business. We spoke to five professionals who use their blogs for just that



Mohit Maheshwari
Web Strategist
Ishir Infotech

I have been reading blogs by Rajesh Jain and other such eminent Indian and foreign IT personalities for two years. Also, James Rick Stinson, a client of my company and a blogger himself, encouraged me to start my own blog. So I began blogging in June 2004. I am a great fan of photoblogging and Moblogging (mobile blogging).

I use my blog as a medium to express my opinion on new events, happenings, etc, in the Internet industry. The Indian Online Advertising Conclave 2004 saw me fly down from Delhi to Mumbai so I could cover it on my blog. Among the people impressed by my coverage was Ajit Balakrishnan, CEO of Rediff.com, who commended my job via e-mail.

While talking business, Dave Vallauri, Chief Executive Officer, LodgingInteractive.com, another client, said that he has developed a much better perspective about India after reading my blog. A passion for IT saw me leave my chartered accountancy studies halfway through to pursue a career in this industry. Blogging is now helping me keep this passion alive and thriving.